



CONCEPT PITCH

VIGIL

The AI personal trainer that notices when you don't show up.

Prepared as an exploratory concept — not a live product.

01 — THE PROBLEM

Fitness apps got smarter. Retention didn't.



Most “AI” features are reactive

They generate a better plan — but still wait for you to open the app and start the conversation.



Personalization improved plans, not follow-through

Smarter programming hasn't moved the number that actually matters: whether people keep showing up.



Nobody calls you when you go quiet

No mainstream app notices a skipped session and reaches out the way a real coach would.

~90%

of new fitness apps lose most of their users within the first 30 days, per industry churn analyses.

\$14–58B

is the spread analysts give for the AI-in-fitness market by the mid-2030s. Estimates vary wildly — the direction doesn't.

Plenty of AI coaches. None that call you out.

App	Workout Plans	Wearable Data	Form Check	Remembers You	Reaches Out First
Fitbod	Yes	Partial	No	Partial	No
Freeletics	Yes	No	No	Partial	Scripted only
Dr. Muscle	Yes	Partial	No	Yes	No
Future (human coach)	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes — human texts you
Future's AI product	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Discontinued in 2026



The pattern across every row: real product, real engineering — and still nothing that notices when you go quiet and says something first.

03 — A REALITY CHECK

The biggest player in this space just walked this back.



In 2026, Future — the largest virtual personal training platform — built a pure-AI coaching product, then discontinued it and recommitted fully to human coaches.

Only about 10% of people globally say they'd prefer AI workout guidance over a human coach — barely higher among Gen Z and Millennials, per Les Mills' 2026 Global Fitness Report.

This is a real headwind, not a footnote — any pitch for Vigil has to answer it directly.

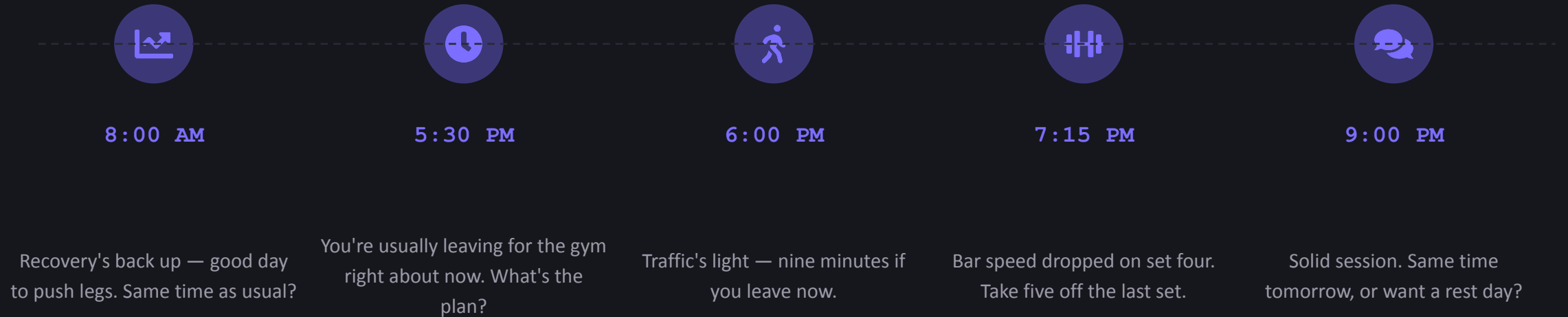
WHAT THIS MEANS FOR VIGIL

Vigil can't win by pretending to be a human coach. It has to win by doing the one thing humans can't scale: watching every day, noticing immediately, and reaching out — for a fraction of the price.

Position as the layer between sessions with a human coach, or the accountability tier for people priced out of one — not a replacement for either.

04 — THE INSIGHT

The gap isn't intelligence. It's initiative.



Almost no consumer fitness app behaves this way today. Current AI coaches mostly wait for you to open them and ask.

Four pillars, one always-on coach.



Trainer & personality

Pick a discipline (strength, conditioning, mobility, HIIT) and a tone (motivator, drill sergeant, chill coach, mentor).



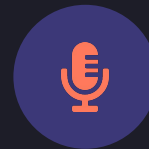
Adaptive coaching engine

Sleep, recovery, and streak data reshape today's session automatically — before you even open the app.



Proactive accountability

Vigil messages first. It notices a skipped session and starts the conversation, instead of waiting for one.



Voice & camera interaction

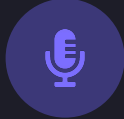
Hands-free logging by voice, and phone-camera form checks on rep quality, tempo, and range of motion.

Every level removes one more excuse.



01 Manual check-in

Log sets and reps by text after each one. Works on day one, in any gym.



02 Voice conversation

Earbuds in, hands free — say “done,” get the next set.



03 Computer vision

Phone camera flags tempo, range of motion, and bar path in real time.



04 Wearable data

Sleep, HRV, and recovery reshape the plan before you train.



05 Automatic detection

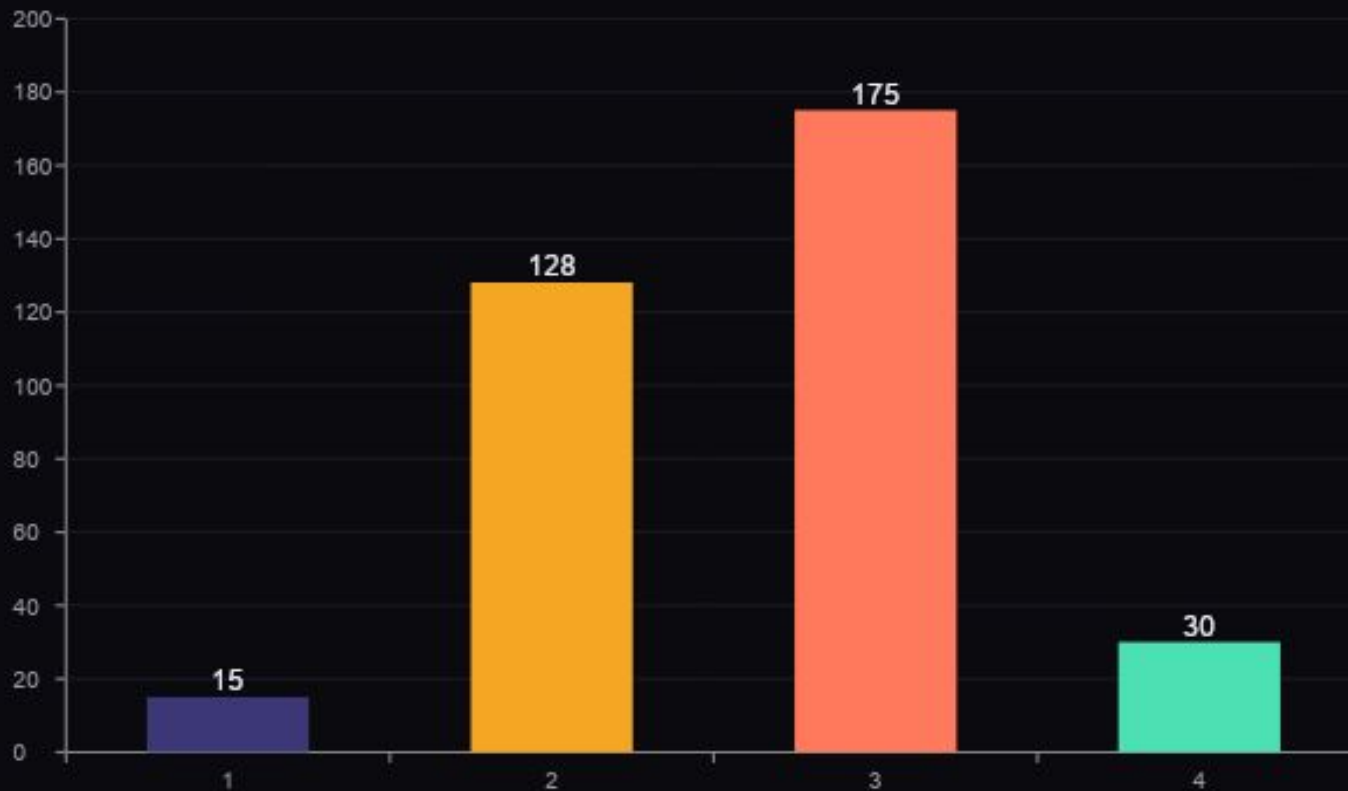
Vigil recognizes the station you're at and starts the timer itself.



06 Full autonomy

Every session, injury, and excuse — remembered and reasoned about.

Priced between a template and a trainer.



READING THIS CHART

Figures are pulled from public pricing pages, not confirmed unit economics — directional, not a forecast.

Template apps are cheap but static. Human coaching works but costs \$150–200/month. The open lane sits in between: AI that's genuinely proactive, at software pricing.

Target buyer: people who've tried template apps and quit, but can't justify \$150+/month for a human.

What ships first, and what waits.



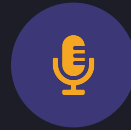
Phase 0 — Prototype

Interactive concept + working chat demo. Validates tone, UX, and whether the idea lands. Done.



Phase 1 — MVP

One trainer, chat-based logging, scheduled proactive nudges, persistent memory. ~4–6 weeks solo.



Phase 2 — Senses

Wearable data (Apple Health / Google Fit), voice input, richer adaptive plan logic. ~6–8 weeks.



Phase 3 — Full loop

Camera-based form check, analytics dashboard, automatic gym detection, monetization. ~8–12 weeks.

What this needs to go from concept to code.



Validate demand first

Talk to 15–20 people who've quit a fitness app in under a month. Confirm the proactive-nudge idea is what's actually missing for them.



Scope the Phase 1 build

One trainer, one personality, chat-based accountability loop. Buildable solo in 4–6 weeks with Claude Code.



Decide on positioning

Standalone app competing on accountability, or a proactive-coaching feature layered into an existing platform?